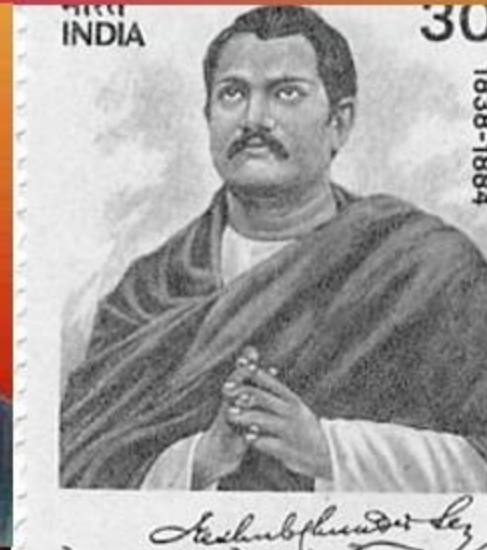


MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



Raja Ram Mohan Roy
22 May 1772 – 27 September 1833



MODULE - 1

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS REFORM MOVEMENTS PART-1

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

CAUSES OF SOCIAL AWAKENING

Socio-religious reforms in the 19th century **provided the soil for growth of Indian Nationalism.**

Main reason of emergence was spread of western Education and liberal ideas

Detrimental effect of the Christian missionaries

British rule and its deep influence on political, economic, social and culture life of India

Effort of the European Orientalists, put India's glorious past into limelight.

- This includes work done by Sir William Jones, James Prinsep, Charles Wilkins, Max Muller etc.
- Many Indian scholars such as Raja Rammohan Roy, Radhakanta Deb, Rajendralal Mitra, MG Ranade etc. also contributed in reinterpreting India's past

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

CAUSES OF SOCIAL AWAKENING

REFORMISM VERSUS REVIVALISM

All the social awakening movements can be grouped into two schools viz.
Reformist and Revivalist.

REFORMISTS

This school of thought wanted to bring reform in the society by inculcating western education and liberal ideas.

One example of such movement is **Brahmo Samaj**.

REVIVALISTS

This school of thought believed that the western thinking would ruin Indian culture and ethos, and thus there was a need to revive former customs or practices and thus take the society back to the glorious past

One example of such movement is **Arya Samaj**.

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

We can study socio-religious movements under nine divisions-

SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS

HINDU REFORM MOVEMENTS

**OTHER SECULAR/ NON- HINDU
REFORM MOVEMENTS**

PARSI REFORM MOVEMENTS

ANTI-UNTOUCHABILITY MOVEMENTS

SIKH MOVEMENTS

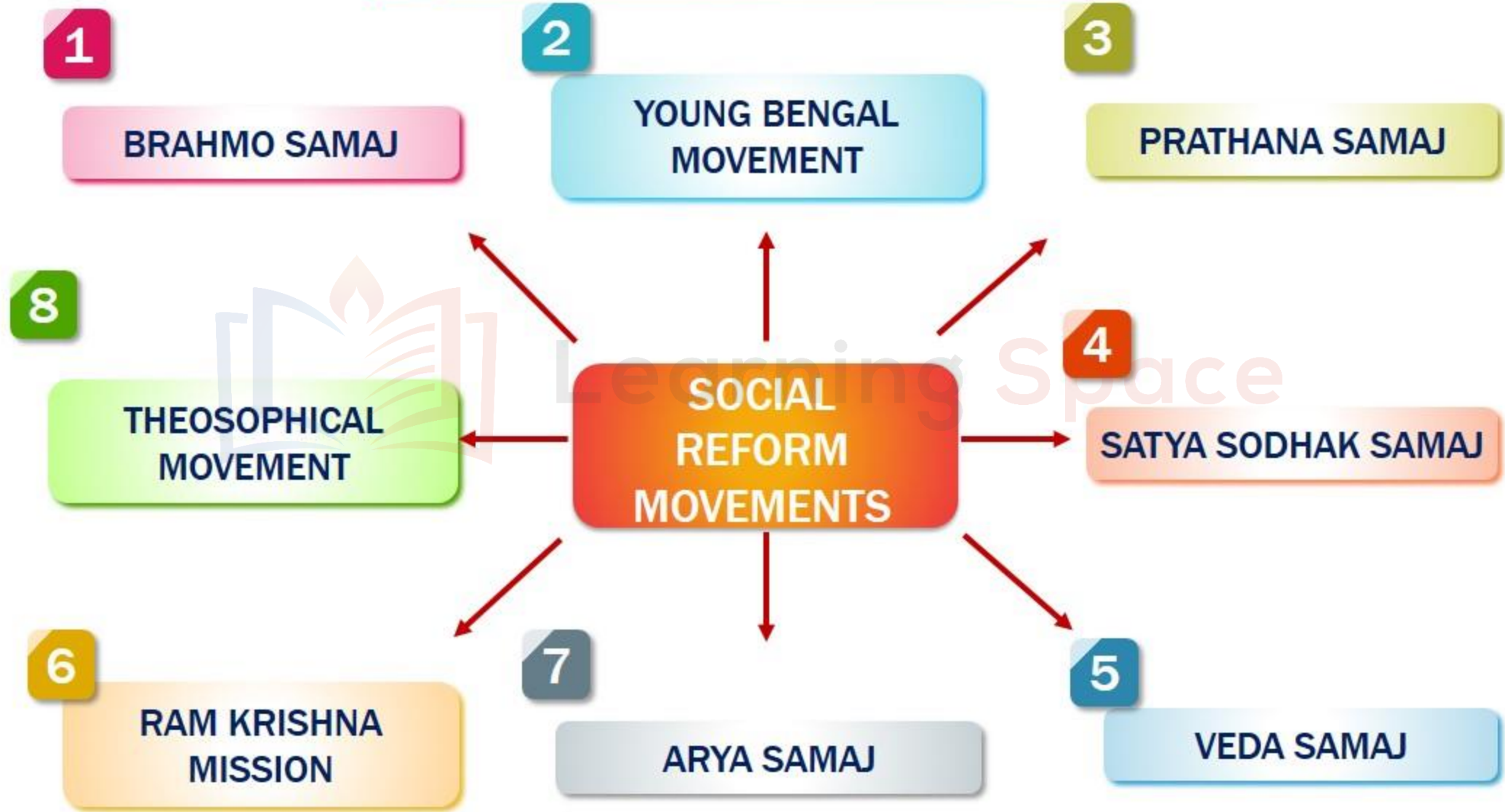
ISLAMIC REFORM MOVEMENTS

DEPRESSED CASTE MOVEMENTS

MOVEMENTS FOR THE EMANCIPATION OF WOMEN

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS



SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS

BRAHMO SAMAJ

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)



He is known as “*Father of Modern India*”; “*Father of Indian Renaissance*” and “*bridge between past and future*”.

He **believed in modern scientific approach** and principles of human dignity and social equality.

He put his **faith in monotheism**. He **wrote *Gift to Monotheists*** and translated *Vedas and the five Upanishads* into Bengali to prove his conviction that ancient Hindu texts support monotheism.

In his *Precepts of Jesus* (1820), he tried to separate the moral and philosophical message of the New Testament. Not only this he earned the wrath of missionaries over his advocacy to incorporate the message of Christ into Hinduism.



SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY
(1772-1833)

ATMIYA SABHA
(1814)

(SOCIETY OF FRIENDS)

To propagate the
monotheistic
ideals of the
Vedanta

To campaign
against idolatry,
caste rigidities,
meaningless
rituals and other
social ills

He was man of
rational thoughts
and declared
that *Vedanta is
based on
reason.*

BRAHMO SABHA
(1828)

(SOCIETY OF BRAHMA)

Later renamed
Brahmo Samaj

The long-term agenda
of the Brahmo Samaj
was to purify Hinduism
and to preach
monotheism



SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

BRAHMO SABHA (1828)

FEATURES OF BRAHMO SAMAJ

DENOUNCED POLYTHEISM AND IDOL WORSHIP

- Believed in worshipping of Eternal being who is Author and Preserver of the Universe.
- Instead of idol or meaningless rituals; readings of Upanishads and meditation were to be the forms of worship.

DISCARDED INCARNATIONS

It believes that there is only one God and there are no incarnations.

RATIONALITY AND CONSCIOUSNESS

It emphasized on logical and scientific temper instead of superstitious or conservative or orthodox.

DOCTRINE OF KARMA AND TRANSMIGRATION OF SOUL

Took no definite stand on the doctrine of karma and transmigration of soul and left it to individual Brahmos to believe either way.

CRITICISED THE CASTE SYSTEM

It believed in equality, egalitarian and non-discrimination.



SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY'S EFFORTS AT SOCIAL REFORM- WITH RESPECT TO WOMEN

His efforts were rewarded by the Government Regulation in 1829 which declared the practice of sati a crime.

Against the
inhuman
practice of sati.

Condemned the
general **subjugation**
of women

**Demanded the right of
inheritance and property
for women**

WOMEN

Attacked
polygamy

**Demanded
education for
women**

Attacked
**degraded state of
widows**



SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY'S EFFORTS AT SOCIAL REFORM

EDUCATION SPHERE

Rammohan Roy did much to disseminate the benefits of modern education to his countrymen.

He supported David Hare's efforts to found the Hindu College in 1817.

In 1825, he established a Vedanta college where courses in both Indian learning and Western social and physical sciences were offered.

Rammohan was a gifted linguist. He knew more than a dozen languages including Sanskrit, Persian, Arabic, English, French, Latin, Greek and Hebrew.

POLITICAL ACTIVIST

Supported freedom of the Press and brought out journals in Bengali, Hindi, English, Persian to educate the public and represent their grievances before the government.

Roy condemned oppressive practices of Bengali zamindars and demanded fixation of maximum rents and abolition of taxes on tax free lands.

He called for a reduction of export duties on Indian goods abroad and abolition of the East India Company's trading rights.





SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY'S EFFORTS AT SOCIAL REFORM

ADMINISTRATIVE ACTIVIST

He demanded the Indianisation of superior services

He demanded separation of the executive from the judiciary.

He demanded judicial equality between Indians and Europeans and that trial be held by jury.

INTERNATIONALIST

He stood for cooperation of thought and activity and brotherhood among nations.

His understanding of the universal character of the principles of liberty, equality and justice indicated that he well understood the significance of the modern age.

He supported the revolutions of Naples and Spanish America and condemned the oppression of Ireland by absentee English landlordism



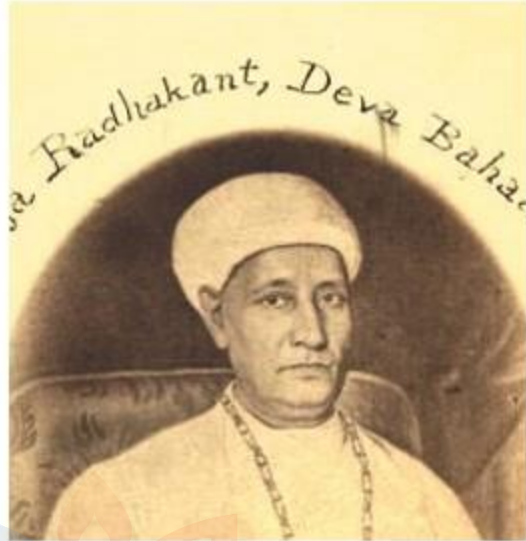
SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

BRAHMO SABHA (1828)



BRAHMO SAMAJ-
RAJA RAM MOHAN ROY



DHARMA SABHA-
RAJA RADHAKANT DEB

Roy's death in 1833 was a setback for the Samaj's mission.

Rammohan Roy did not want to establish a new religion. He only wanted to purify Hinduism of the evil practices which had crept into it.

Roy's progressive ideas met with strong opposition from orthodox elements like Raja Radhakant Deb who organised the Dharma Sabha to counter Brahmo Samaj propaganda.

Prominent followers of Brahmo samaj were the Derozians and independent thinkers such as Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and Ashwini Kumar Datta.



SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

DEBENDRANATH TAGORE AND BRAHMO SAMAJ



DEBENDRANATH TAGORE
(1817-1905)

FATHER OF RABINDRANATH TAGORE

He headed the Tattvabodhini Sabha (founded in 1839) which published Tattvabodhini Patrika in Bengali.

This sabha was devoted to the systematic study of India's past with a rational outlook and to the propagation of Rammohan's ideas.

He gave a new life to Brahmo Samaj and a definite form and shape, when he joined the Samaj in 1842.



SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

KESHAB CHANDRA SEN AND THE BRAHMO SAMAJ



KESHAB CHANDRA SEN
(1838-1884)

He joined the Samaj in 1858.

Brahmo Samaj experienced another phase of energy, when Keshab Chandra Sen was made the acharya by Debendranath Tagore

He was instrumental in popularising the movement, and thus branches of the Samaj were opened outside Bengal—in the United Provinces, Punjab, Bombay, Madras and other towns.

He established small society known as Sangat Sabha ('Friendly Association') in 1859. Its main objective was to discuss the spiritual and social problems of the day.





SOCIO-CULTURAL REFORM MOVEMENTS AND THEIR LEADERS

RAJA RAMMOHAN ROY (1772-1833)

KESHAB CHANDRA SEN AND THE BRAHMO SAMAJ



KESHAB CHANDRA SEN
(1838-1884)

Under Sangat Sabha, he also launched humanitarian and philanthropic activities, such as providing help during famines and epidemics.

In 1861, he launched a fortnightly journal "Indian Mirror" which later became First Indian Daily in English in 1871.

He tried to make Brahmo Samaj an all-India movement. As a result Ved Samaj was established in Madras and Prarthana Samaj in Maharashtra.

He strove for radical social changes and emerged as a staunch supporter of emancipation of women, female education, inter-caste marriages and launched an organized campaign against child marriage.





BRAHMO SAMAJ

SCHISM IN BRAHMO SAMAJ

In 1866, the **radical reforms by Keshab Chandra Sen** led to a schism in Brahmo sabha. Debendranath did not like some of Sen's ideas which he found too radical, **such as cosmopolitanisation of the Samaj's meetings by inclusion of teachings from all religions and his strong views against the caste system, even open support to inter-caste marriages.**



ADI BRAHMO SAMAJ

Slogan of Adi Brahmo Samaj was "***Brahmoism is Hinduism***"



BRAHMO SAMAJ OF INDIA OR NAV VIDHANA

Slogan was "***Brahmoism is Catholic and Universal***" i.e. an attempt to combine Christian and Hindu ideals and practices, marking a distinct break with Hinduism.



BRAHMO SAMAJ

SCHISM IN BRAHMO SAMAJ OF INDIA

ACTIVITIES OF NAV VIDHANA

He rallied for putting the **Brahmo Marriage Act** in statute book legalizing the marriage as per Brahmo rites. As per this act, minimum age of marriage was 14 years and it allowed inter-caste marriage.

He established the *Indian Reform Association*, which greatly worked for the spread of western education, emancipation of women, female education and social work.

ACTIVITIES WHICH CREATED DISSENSION AND DIVISION

He gave his daughter in marriage to Maharaja of Cooch Behar in 1878, both the bride and groom were under-age. Not only this, marriage was conducted as per Hindu rites and this violated the **Brahmo Marriage Act of 1872**.

Further, Keshub was accused of authoritarianism.

His organization failed in the end

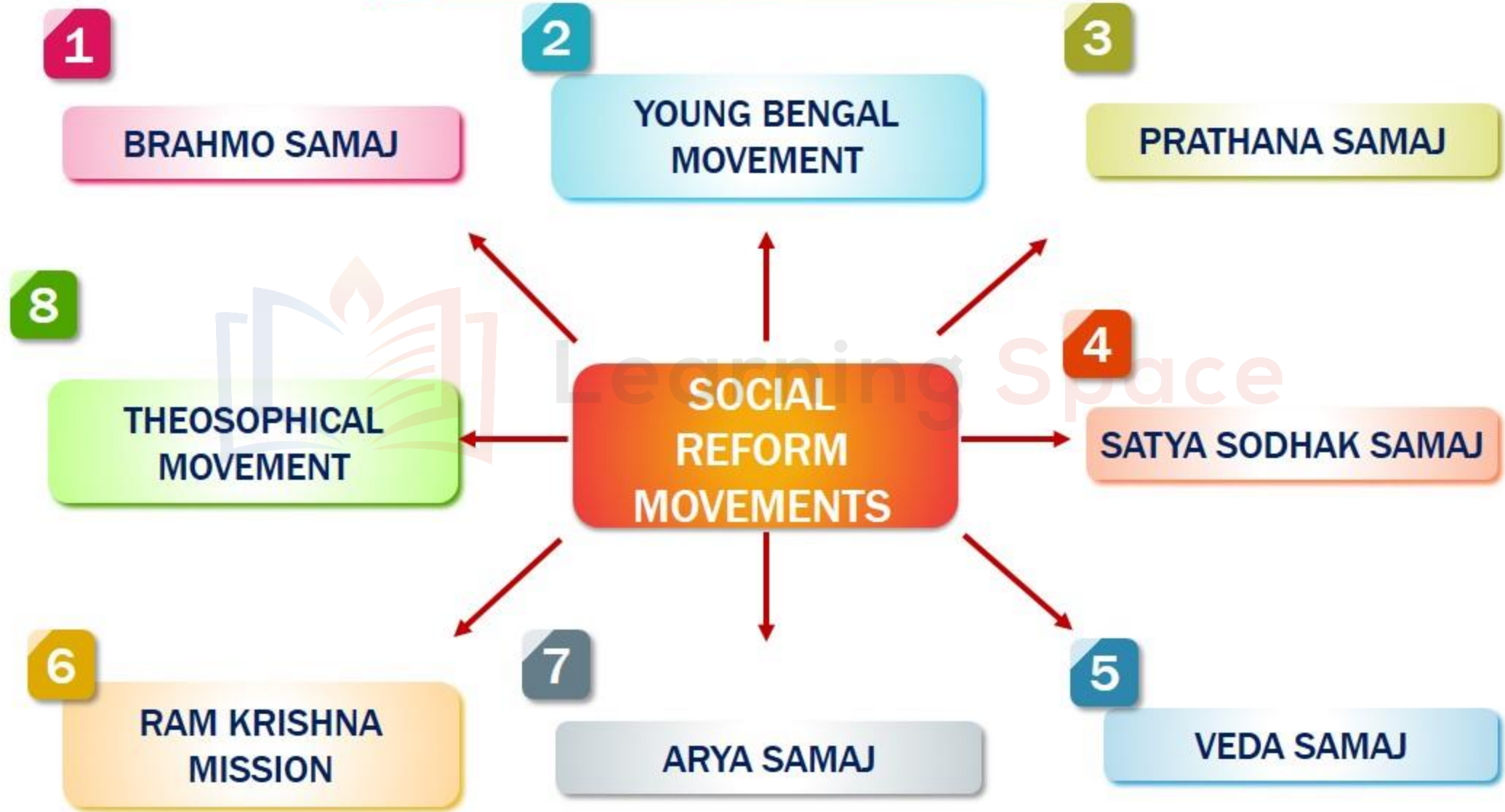
Many of Nav Vidhana members separated from Keshab and established the **Sadharana Brahmo Samaj**, whose constitution was drafted by **Anand Mohan Bose**, based on democratic principles and gave equal rights to all members in the management of the Samaj.

In Punjab, **Dayal Singh Trust** sought to implant Brahmo ideas by opening of **Dayal Singh College** at Lahore in 1910.



SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS



1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS

YOUNG BENGAL MOVEMENT

HENRY VIVIAN DEROZIO (1809-1831)

Derozio was perhaps the first nationalist poet of modern India.



He was inspired from the great French Revolution

ABOUT HENRY VIVIAN DEROZIO

He had come to Calcutta in 1826 and was appointed in the Hindu College as a teacher of English literature and History.

Surendranath Banerjea describe the Derozians as “the pioneers of the modern civilisation of Bengal, the conscript fathers of our race whose virtues will excite veneration and whose failings will be treated with gentlest consideration”.

YOUNG BENGAL MOVEMENT

Movement which was influenced by Derozian philosophy was known as the Young Bengal Movement.

ABOUT THE MOVEMENT

He inspired his pupils to think freely and rationally, question all authority, love liberty, equality and freedom, and oppose decadent customs and traditions.

Objective of Derozains

- Supported women's rights and Education.
- Induction of Indians in higher services,
- Protection of ryots from oppressive zamindars,
- Better treatment to Indian labour abroad in British colonies,
- Revision of the Company's charter,
- Freedom of press and trial by jury.

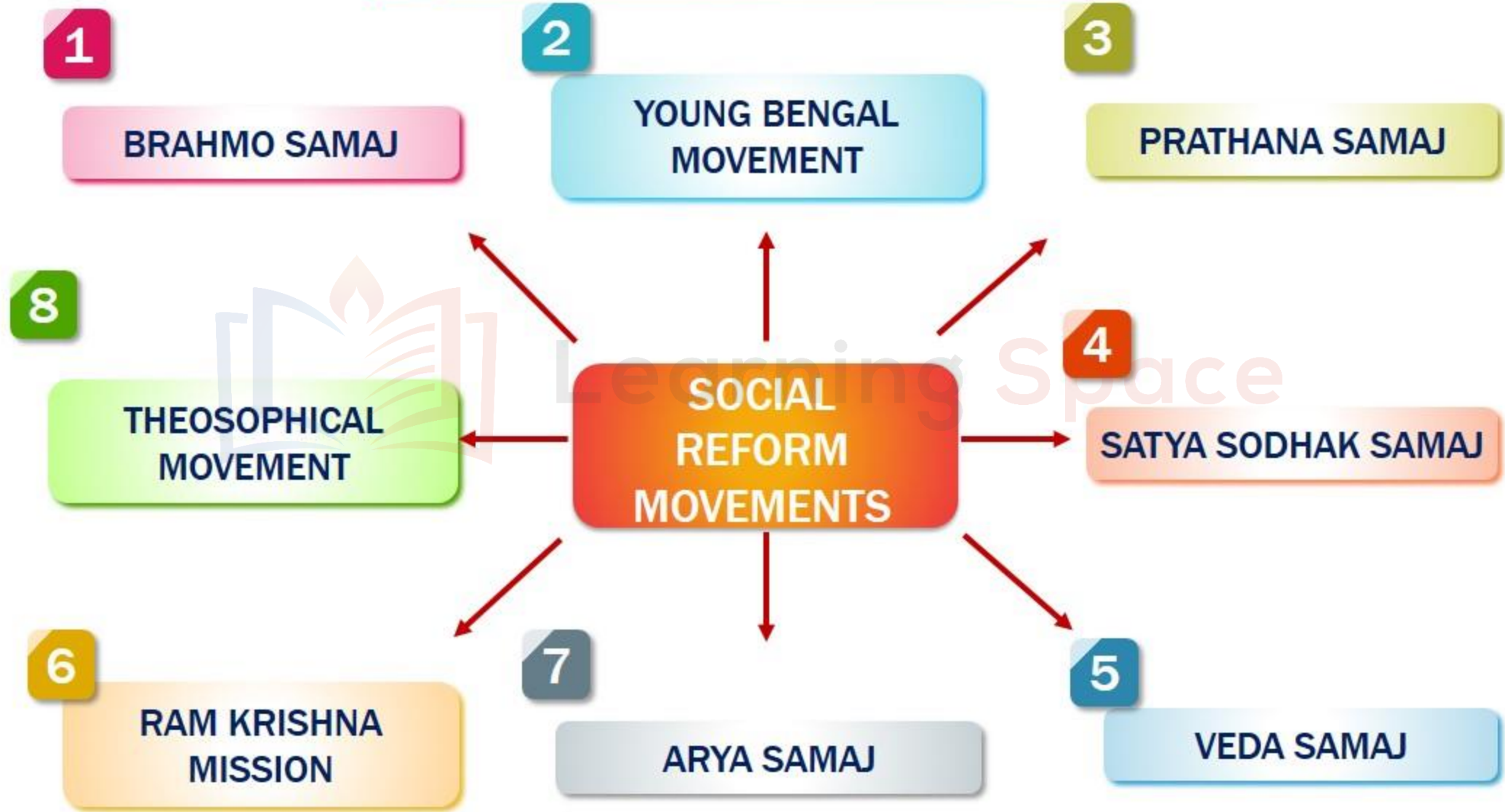
WHY THE MOVEMENT FADED?

Like Socrates, he pursued what was right and was accused of misguiding the youth. Some influential Hindus had him removed from service and shortly thereafter, he died.

- Derozians lacked any real link with the masses;
- They failed to take up peasants cause.
- Their radicalism was bookish in character.

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS



PRARTHANA SAMAJ, 1867 (BOMBAY)

ATMARAM PANDURANG

A precursor of Prarthana Samaj was Paramahansa Sabha. Emphasis was on monotheism, but on the whole, the samaj was more concerned with social reforms than with religion



Important leaders of the Samaj were-

- Mahadeo Govind Ranade,
- R.G. Bhandarkar,
- Dhondo Keshav Karve and
- Vishnu Shastri.

Samaj relied on education and persuasion and not on confrontation with Hindu orthodoxy.

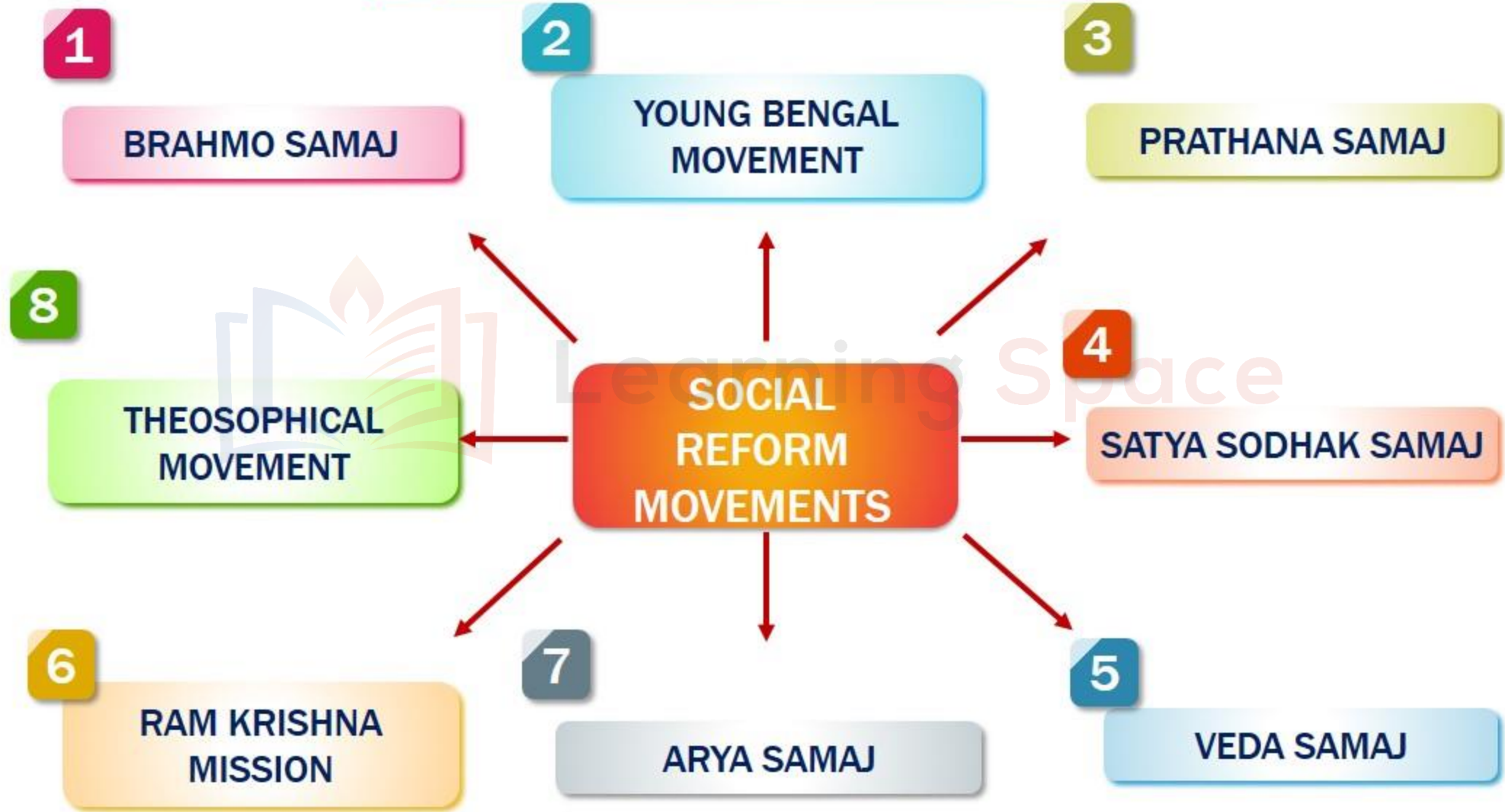
There was a four-point social agenda:

- disapproval of caste system,
- women's education
- widow remarriage, and
- raising the age of marriage for both males and females.

Along with Karve, Ranade founded the Widow Remarriage Movement as well as Widows' Home Association with the aim of providing education and training to widows so that they could support themselves.

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS



1

SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS

SATYASHODHAK SAMAJ, 1873

(Truth Seekers' Society)

JYOTIBA OR JYOTIRAO PHULE (1827-1890)

Born in Satara, Maharashtra, **belonged to mali (gardener) community and organised a powerful movement against upper caste domination and Brahminical supremacy**

JYOTIBA PHULE AND SAVITRI BAI PHULE



The main aims of the movement were

- (i) **social service**, and
- (ii) **spread of education among women and lower caste people.**

— Phule used the **symbol of Rajah Bali** as opposed to the **brahmins' symbol of Rama.**

TWO IMPORTANT WORKS

SARVAJANIK
SATYADHARMA

GULAMGIRI

SATYASHODHAK SAMAJ, 1873

This movement gave a sense of identity to the depressed communities

Believer in gender equality, was a pioneer in women's education. With the help of his wife, Savitribai, opened a girls' school at Poona

Against Sanskritic Hinduism

Aimed at the complete abolition of the caste system and socio-economic inequalities



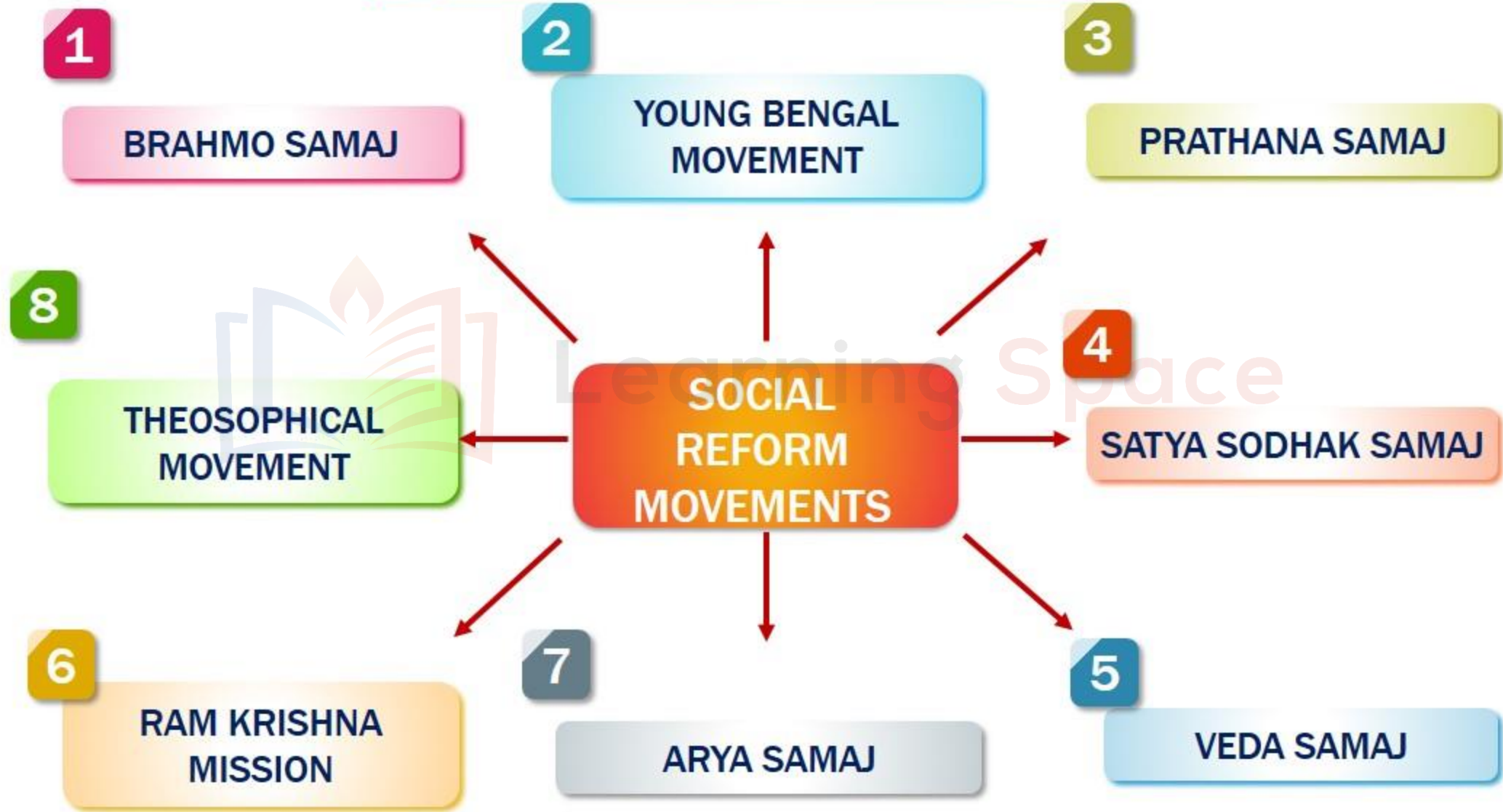
He was a pioneer of widow remarriage movement in Maharashtra and also opened a home for widows in 1854

Phule was awarded the title 'Mahatma' for his social reform work.

JYOTIBA PHULE AND SAVITRI BAI PHULE

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS



VEDA SAMAJ, 1864 (MADRAS)

K. SRIDHARALU NAIDU



Veda Samaj was established by Keshab Chandra Sen and K. Sridharalu Naidu

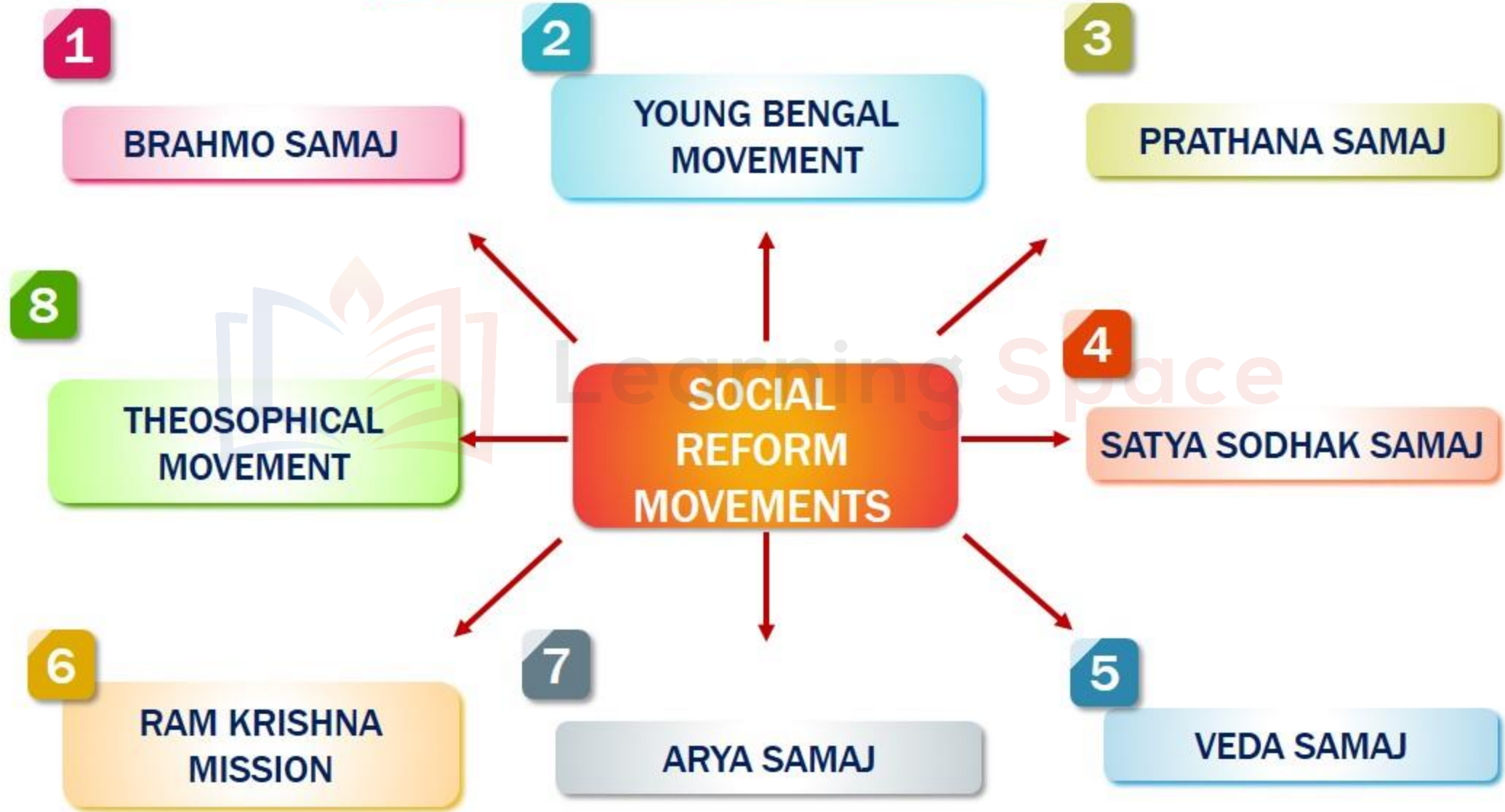
K. Sridharalu Naidu renamed Veda Samaj as *Brahmo Samaj of Southern India* in 1871.

He translated the books of Brahmo Dharma into Tamil and Telugu and undertook missionary tours to propagate the faith

However, Naidu's untimely death in 1874 in an accident led to several schisms into this organization.

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS



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